IGCSE 0607 Practice Questions — E8.3

Magnitude of a vector

Total Questions: 9 — **Total Marks:** 57 Marks

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1 Vector $\mathbf{v}$ is given as

$$\mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ -12 \end{pmatrix}$$

Work out $|\mathbf{v}|$, the magnitude of vector $\mathbf{v}$.

..... **[2]**

2 Given the vectors $\mathbf{p} = \begin{pmatrix} -8 \\ 15 \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{q} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -4 \end{pmatrix}$.

(a) Calculate $|\mathbf{p}|$.

..... **[2]**

(b) Calculate $|\mathbf{p} + 2\mathbf{q}|$.

..... **[3]**

3 Vector $\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ x+2 \end{pmatrix}$.

(a) The magnitude of vector **u** is 10.
Show that $x^2 + 2x - 48 = 0$.

[3]

(b) Solve the equation

$$x^2 + 2x - 48 = 0$$

$x =$ ..... , $x =$ ..... **[2]**

(c) Hence write down the two possible column vectors for **u**.

[2]

4 Points A, B, and C have coordinates $(3, -2)$, $(-5, y)$, and $(7, 1)$ respectively.

(a) Calculate $|\vec{AC}|$.

..... **[2]**

(b) The magnitude of vector $\vec{AB}$ is 17.
Work out the two possible values of y.

$y =$ ..... , $y =$ ..... **[5]**

5 **(a)** The points A and B have coordinates $(2, -3)$ and $(9, 4)$ respectively.
Work out the column vector $\vec{AB}$.

$\begin{pmatrix} \quad \\ \quad \end{pmatrix}$ **[2]**

(b) Calculate $|\vec{AB}|$.
Give your answer correct to 3 significant figures.

..... **[2]**

(c) Vector $\mathbf{p} = \begin{pmatrix} k \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$.
Given that $|\mathbf{p}| = 5$, find the two possible values of k.

$k =$ ..... , $k =$ ..... **[3]**

6 Given the vectors $\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} 2k \\ k-3 \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} k+1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$.

(a) Given that $|\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}| = \sqrt{50}$, show that $5k^2 + 2k - 24 = 0$.

[4]

(b) Solve the equation

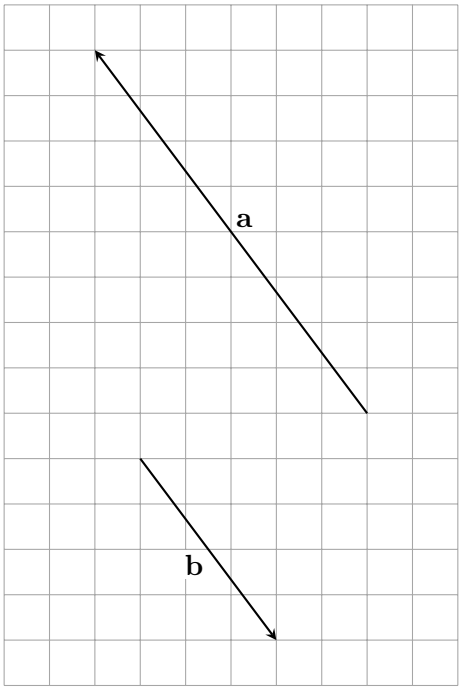
$$5k^2 + 2k - 24 = 0$$

$k =$ ..... , $k =$ ..... **[4]**

(c) Hence, find the two possible column vectors for $\mathbf{u}$.

$\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} \quad \\ \quad \end{pmatrix}$ ..... , $\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} \quad \\ \quad \end{pmatrix}$ ..... **[2]**

7 The diagram shows vectors **a** and **b** drawn on a square grid.



(a) Work out $|\mathbf{a}|$.

$|\mathbf{a}| =$ ..... **[2]**

(b) Work out $|2\mathbf{a} + 3\mathbf{b}|$.

$|2\mathbf{a} + 3\mathbf{b}| =$ ..... **[3]**

8 The points P, Q and R have coordinates $(2, -3)$, $(k, 5)$ and $(4, 1)$ respectively.

(a) Given that $|\vec{PQ}| = 10$, find the two possible values of k.

$k =$ ..... , or $k =$ ..... **[4]**

(b) Using the positive value of k from part (a), calculate the magnitude of $\vec{QR}$.
Give your answer correct to 3 significant figures.

$|\vec{QR}| =$ ..... **[3]**

9 **(a)** The vector $\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} p \\ p \end{pmatrix}$, where $p > 0$.

Given that $|\mathbf{a}| = \sqrt{18}$, find the value of p.

$p =$ ..... **[2]**

(b) The vectors $\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{v}$ are given by

$$\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \mathbf{v} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

A vector $\mathbf{w}$ is defined as $\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{u} + t\mathbf{v}$.

Given that $|\mathbf{w}| = \sqrt{29}$, find the two possible values of t.

$t =$ ..... , or $t =$ ..... **[5]**